

LETTING SOMEONE GO

A well handled dismissal is not the one nobody feels.

How to let someone go without wrecking the team
that stays.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

It is the one everybody understands.

THE CASCADE

What happens when nobody explains.

WHAT YOU SEE

The person leaves with nobody understanding why...

THE MECHANISM

...gossip fills the empty space the explanation left...

THE CONSEQUENCE

...and each person on the team thinks, am I next.

Silence protects nobody, it just hands the story over to fear.

THE FORK

The question that comes before the decision.

BEFORE DECIDING

01

Does holding on poison climate, deadlines and whoever carries it?

02

Have you already warned, trained and followed up, with a real deadline?

03

Yes to both? Then the decision is accountability, not caprice.

Letting go with no warning first is not courage, it is disorganization.

THE METHOD

The three audiences of a dismissal.



01 WHO LEAVES

clarity, dignity and no surprise about the reason

02 WHO STAYS

context, safety and what changes in each person's routine

03 WHO WATCHES

the other teams read the decision as a signal of consistency

The conversation with the person takes fifteen minutes. The care for the team takes weeks.

WHAT TO SAY, IN ORDER

Four messages in the first meeting.

01 • WHO LEAVES

The decision was mine and it is final.

kills the doubt and stops the team hunting for a culprit

02 • WHO STAYS

She knew, she had a deadline and support.

no private details, but the process explained

03 • WHO
WATCHES**This is what changes in your routine, for now.**

who picks up what, and how long it stays temporary

04

Anyone who wants to talk, my door is open.

and deliver on that in the following week, one by one

TWO MODELS

A dismissal that scares or one that steadies.

THE COMMON MODEL

Scares

Nobody saw it coming

The team finds out from the badge

No explanation about the process

Work reassigned in a panic

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Steadies

There was warning, deadline and support

The team hears it from you first

Process explained, reason respected

Reassignment agreed and temporary

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three mistakes that cost months of trust.

01 Speaking badly of whoever just left.

- everyone understands this is how it will go when it is their turn.

02 Pretending nothing happened at the next meeting.

- the team spends the whole week reading the silence.

03 Pushing the work over with no deadline and no priority.

- whoever stays feels punished for still being here.

Whoever stays watches how you treated whoever left, and draws conclusions.

THE CHAIN

The Monday silence test.

01

A week has passed since the exit.



02

Nobody on the team came to you with a question?



03

That is rarely acceptance, it is almost always fear.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

If nobody asks, you go to them. One by one, with no audience.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

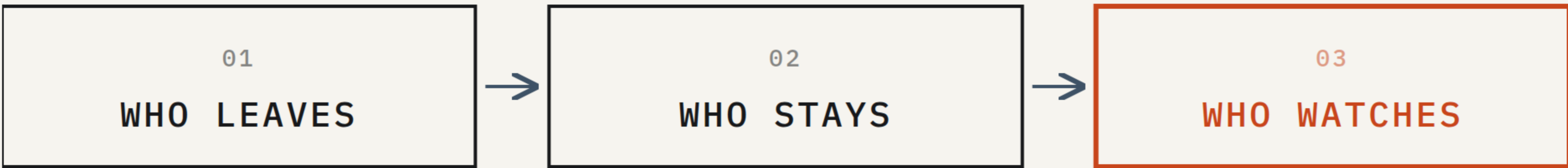
The script for the week of the decision.

▣ STEP 01 Tell the team the same day, yourself, with no hedging. before the information circulates in the wrong version	▣ STEP 02 Define who picks up what, with a review date. reassignment with no deadline becomes permanent overload	■ STEP 03 Have one individual conversation with each person that week. that is where the fear nobody voices in a group shows up
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The dismissal ends when the people who stayed are producing calmly again.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Three Audiences, in the order that matters.



A dismissal does not end at the exit. It ends when the people who stay trust again.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER
in the next hard decision about your team.

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